Discussion Of A Practice-Led Collaboration Between A Writer/Curator And Composer/Sound Artist

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Lea and Mary's collaboration involves the production of sound works for exhibitions using vocal and story fragments contributed by community participants. Alongside this they have an emerging theoretical collaboration which extends the dialogic form of their practice.

Mary is currently a visiting fellow at the Research School of Humanities and the Arts, Australian National University. She is a writer, museum exhibition curator and public historian. Her work has been produced and commissioned by ABC Radio and a range of Australian theatre companies. She has worked on numerous community projects and also has extensive experience in researching and developing historical and other cultural material for museum exhibitions, site specific heritage interpretations, publications and public art. Her academic background includes undergraduate qualifications in history and postgraduate qualifications in community/adult education. Her most recent research is in the field of museum studies and concerns making exhibitions of local Australian migration history in collaboration with community participants.

Lea studied electro acoustic composition with David Worrall, Tim Kreger and Warren Burt at ACAT graduating in 1997. Her artistic practice now covers the creation of site specific collaborative installation and sound work in venues such as the National Archives of Australia, the National Museum of Australia, collection of aural culture for the National Library of Australia's as well as a continuing involvement in theatre, performance and teaching. She has worked extensively in multi media, digital production and sound design providing audio, visual and technical services for venues such as Parliament House, the National Convention Centre and other corporate multi media production environments. She has developed training materials for broadcast and digital media courses at the NTU, CIT, Uni of Canberra and vocational training providers. Between 2004 and 2009 she taught at ANU with Alistair Riddell.

Collaborative projects include:

- *Migration Memories*, 2006-07, exhibitions exploring migration histories shown at the National Museum of Australia and in local venues at Lightning Ridge and Robinvale. ARC linkage grant NMA and ANU partnership.

- *Intimate Geographies*, Huw Davies Gallery, PhotoAccess, Canberra May 2005.

- *Voices of Bonegilla*, 2003, National Archives of Australia supplement to touring exhibition from Albury Regional Museum.

- Mary Hutchison and Lea Collins, 'Translations: experiments in dialogic representation of cultural diversity in three museum sound installations' in *Museum and Society*, July 2009. http://www.le.ac.uk/ms/museumsociety.html